

Guidelines for preparing CHE 260 lab reports

Lab report submission:

One report is required for each group performing an experiment. The lab report is due ONE week after the lab session. A 10% penalty will be applied for each day the report is late.

Use of AI:

The ability to communicate engineering knowledge effectively across a range of contexts and audiences is a key learning objective in this course. Your submitted assignments must demonstrate this learning objective, and as such, should be your own original and independent work. Copying a report, in whole or in part, will be considered plagiarism. Any work submitted with the direct or indirect use of AI tools must be acknowledged in a form appropriate to the use, and failing to do so may result in academic offence. Generative AI tools (such as but not limited to ChatGPT) may not be used to create text for use in your assignments. However, generative AI tools may serve as a tool for parts of the writing process, such as brainstorming, outlining, and research, but must be acknowledged appropriately. When acknowledging your use of Generative AI tools, please do the following: provide a citation in your works cited using the following format:

"Tool Name, URL, Date used, Description how it was used, Prompt(s) used."

Since similar prompts will generate different responses at different times, if you use generative AI as a source, you must include a screenshot of the output in an appropriately titled appendix.

Report structure:

Reports are limited to a total length of 10 double-spaced pages. This includes all relevant tables and figures. The report must be typewritten with a minimum font size of 12 pt and double spacing throughout. The overall structure and writing quality will also be considered when grading the lab report. The following structure is recommended:

- **Cover Page:** including the report title (lab title), name and student ID of all members, and the PRA section (e.g. PRA0105).

- **(5%) Introduction:** introducing the subject, main objective(s) of experiments, your main observations throughout the experiments, and the relevant theory. **(Max. 2 pages)**

- **(80%) Results and Discussion:** including results in processed form(s) such as graphs and tables (not raw data), data processing, and analysis. Clearly number all tables and figures and provide an appropriate caption for each. For repetitive calculations, at least one typical calculation should be demonstrated. **Points will be deducted for missing equations, unidentified variables, irrelevant or unlabeled diagrams and tables, missing critical figures, confusing figures, figures that are not referenced in the text, missing units, improper use of significant digits, and missing data.** This section should include a discussion of the results and

answers to the questions. Any assumptions, limitations, and sources of error should also be discussed. **Points will be deducted for insufficient explanation, irrelevant information, and incorrect information.**

- **(5%) Conclusion:** the major outcomes/findings of the experiments will be summarized in this section. **(Max. 1 page)**

- **References:** list all sources referenced in your report. Number the references sequentially in the text, in the order in which they first appear, and list them in the same order in the References section.

Reference Format:

JOURNAL: Author(s), *Journal Title*. Volume (Year) Page number.

BOOK: Author(s), *Book Title*. Publisher, City of publication, Year of publication, Page(s).

WEBSITE: Simply give the website address.

If you use course notes, cite them in the following format:
Author or Course Name. *Title of Document*. Year Accessed.

(10%) Overall Structure and Flow of Lab Report: The report should be well organized and follow the instructions provided above. Please use headings to separate the different sections of the report.